

PROJECT FINAL REPORT

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

ServiceNow Flow Designer – Standard Laptop Procurement Workflow

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Report Date	October 2026
Project Area	IT Procurement Automation
Platform	ServiceNow / Flow Designer

Prepared using the supplied project reference and final report template.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This project presents an automated workflow for standard laptop procurement using ServiceNow Flow Designer. The reference project identifies manual handling, configuration delays and inefficient resource allocation as key problems. The proposed workflow creates a Catalog Task after a service request is approved, updates the task details, assigns it to the Hardware group and connects the flow to the Standard Laptop service catalog item.

The report follows the supplied Final Report Template and reorganizes the reference material into introduction, ideation, requirement analysis, design, planning, testing, results, advantages/disadvantages, conclusion, future scope and appendix sections.

Important source limitation: the supplied reference does not provide measured performance values, dataset links, GitHub/project-demo links, or a formal test-result table. These items are therefore identified as not provided rather than fabricated.

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

The project focuses on streamlining the procurement of standard laptops through ServiceNow. A Standard Laptop request is placed through the Service Catalog. After approval, Flow Designer automatically creates a Catalog Task and assigns it to the Hardware group so that configuration work can begin with less manual intervention.

The supplied reference defines three milestones: creating the flow, assigning the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item, and using the Service Catalog to place and approve the request.

1.2 Purpose

- Provide a seamless process for users requesting standard laptops.
- Automatically create configuration tasks after approval.
- Reduce manual intervention and potential errors.
- Improve resource utilisation through automatic task assignment.
- Reduce waiting time before laptop configuration.

2. IDEATION PHASE

2.1 Problem Statement

The existing standard-laptop procurement process involves manual handling and may delay configuration. The reference specifically notes that configuration can be overlooked or delayed, causing user frustration and inefficient IT resource allocation.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

Derived directly from the reference problem statement and user story; the source does not provide a separate formal empathy-map artifact.

Says	Needs a standard laptop request handled promptly.
Thinks	Configuration should happen without repeated manual follow-up.
Does	Places a Standard Laptop request and waits for approval/configuration.
Feels	May experience frustration when configuration is delayed.
Pain points	Manual intervention, delays, oversight and inefficient allocation.
Needs	A predictable request-to-configuration workflow.

2.3 Brainstorming

- Automate task creation after approval.
- Use Flow Designer as the workflow engine.
- Assign the configuration task directly to Hardware.
- Connect the automation to the Standard Laptop catalog item.
- Keep default fields where the reference does not specify custom values.

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Customer Journey Map

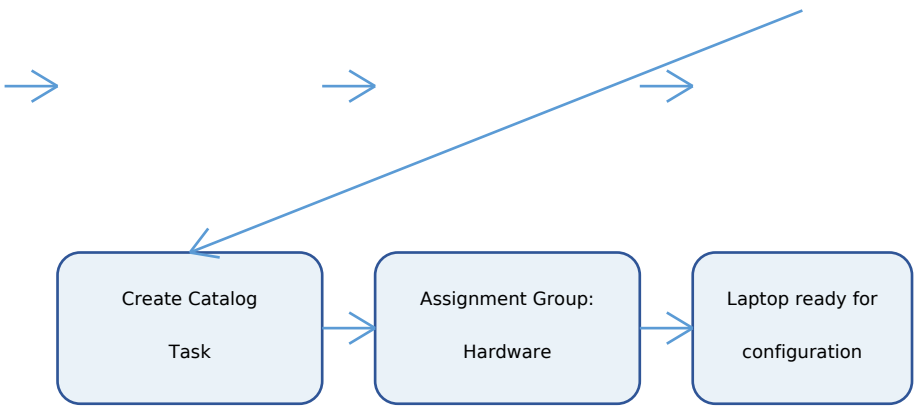
	User/System	Service Catalog	Approval	Output
	User requests Standard Laptop	Service Catalog Request	Approval Approved	Flow Designer Trigger
Trigger	Service Catalog trigger is invoked.		Flow Designer starts the configured flow.	
Task creation	Catalog Task is created from Requested Item Record.		Short description/description indicate laptop configuration.	
Assignment	Task is assigned to Hardware.		Hardware team receives the configuration task.	
Status review	Requested Item and Catalog Tasks are opened to view task status and assignment are visible.		Updated task	

3.2 Solution Requirement

- ServiceNow environment with access to Flow Designer.
- A Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
- A Service Catalog trigger.
- Create Catalog Task action using the Requested Item Record.
- Catalog Task assignment group set to Hardware.
- Approval value set to Approved.
- Flow connected to the Standard Laptop catalog item.

3.3 Data Flow Diagram

The following logical flow is derived from the exact sequence described in the reference report.



3.4 Technology Stack

Technology / Component	Role in Project
ServiceNow	IT service management platform used for the workflow.
Flow Designer	Creates and activates the automation flow.
Service Catalog	Provides the Standard Laptop request interface.
Catalog Task	Represents the configuration task generated by the flow.
Hardware Assignment Group	Receives the configuration task.
Service Catalog Trigger	Starts the flow from the catalog request.

4. PROJECT DESIGN

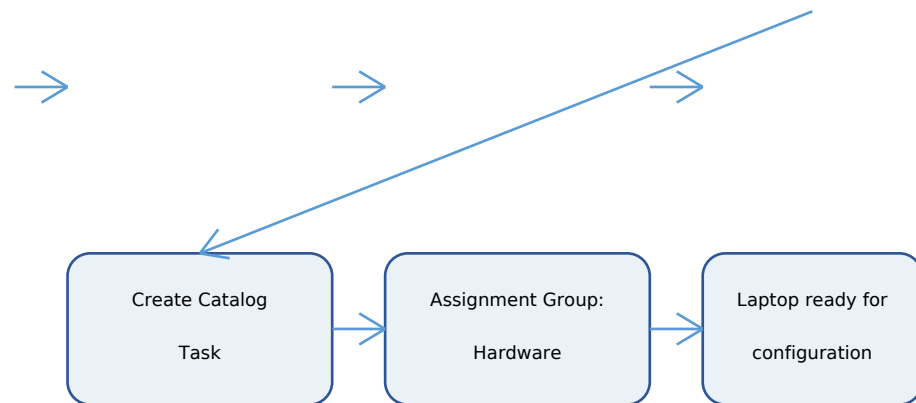
4.1 Problem Solution Fit

- Problem: manual handling and delays → Solution: automated task generation.
- Problem: configuration can be overlooked → Solution: Catalog Task is generated after approval.
- Problem: unclear ownership → Solution: assignment group is set to Hardware.
- Problem: repeated manual intervention → Solution: reusable Flow Designer automation.

4.2 Proposed Solution

Create a Flow named “Standard Laptop Task” in the Global application and run it as the System user. Configure a Service Catalog trigger, followed by a Create Catalog Task action. Use the Requested Item Record, set the task short description and description to “Laptop need to Configured”, set Assignment group to Hardware, set Approval to Approved, save and activate the flow. Then associate the flow with the Standard Laptop catalog item through Maintain Items.

4.3 Solution Architecture



Architecture interpretation: the user-facing Service Catalog initiates the request; approval enables the automation; Flow Designer transforms the approved request into an actionable Catalog Task; the Hardware group handles configuration.

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

5.1 Project Planning

Milestone	Activity	Expected Deliverable
Milestone 1	Create Flow	Standard Laptop Task flow with trigger and Create Catalog
Milestone 2	Flow Assignment	Standard Laptop catalog item connected to the new flow.
Milestone 3	Service Catalog	Request placed, approved and tracked through Requested

Implementation sequence

- Open ServiceNow → All → Flow Designer → New → Flow.
- Set Flow Name: Standard Laptop Task; Application: Global; Run as: System user.
- Add Service Catalog trigger.
- Add Create Catalog Task action and configure requested item, description, Hardware group and Approved value.
- Save and Activate the flow.
- Open Maintain Items → Standard Laptop → Process Engine and add the created flow.
- Place a Standard Laptop order and inspect approval, Requested Item and Catalog Task status.

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

The reference demonstrates a functional verification sequence but does not provide numerical response-time, throughput or load-test measurements. Therefore, this report records the observable functional checks and does not claim quantitative performance results.

Test ID	Functional Check	Expected Result	Reference Evidence
T01	Flow is created with correct name and position.	Standard Laptop Task flow exists.	Milestone 1
T02	Service Catalog trigger is configured.	Flow can start from catalog activity.	Milestone 1
T03	Create Catalog Task action is configured.	Catalog task is generated from Requested Item.	Milestone 1.
T04	Assignment group is set.	Task is assigned to Hardware.	Milestone 1
T05	Flow is linked to Standard Laptop item.	Catalog item uses the created flow.	Milestone 2
T06	Standard Laptop order is placed and approved.	Request progresses to Requested Item.	Milestone 3
T07	Catalog Tasks section is checked.	Updated short description and assigned group visible.	Milestone 3.

7. RESULTS

7.1 Output Screenshots

The supplied reference report describes the output state but does not provide extractable screenshot content in the provided document. The expected output is therefore documented textually below.

Output / Record	Expected Visible Result
Flow Designer	Flow named "Standard Laptop Task", with Service Catalog trigger and Create Catalog Item task.
Standard Laptop catalog item	Process Engine contains the Standard Laptop Task flow.
Request / Approval	Standard Laptop request has an approval record that can be approved.
Requested Item	Requested Item record contains the generated catalog task.
Catalog Task	Task shows short description "Laptop need to Configured" and Assignment group.

Reference implementation sequence

- Place order from Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop → Order Now.
- Open the request number and inspect Approvers.
- Approve the request.
- Open the Requested Item record.
- Scroll to Catalog Tasks and open the generated record.
- Verify updated status, short description and assigned group.

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

Advantages

- Reduces manual intervention in standard laptop procurement.
- Automatically creates a configuration task after approval.
- Assigns work directly to the Hardware team.
- Provides a consistent workflow for standard laptop requests.
- Can improve user experience by reducing configuration delays.

Disadvantages / Limitations

- The supplied reference does not document exception handling for rejected or cancelled requests.
- The reference does not provide quantitative performance measurements.
- The workflow is specifically described for Standard Laptop procurement and may require extension for other hardware types.
- The supplied materials do not include source-code, dataset, GitHub or demo links.

9. CONCLUSION

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow Flow Designer, the project addresses the manual overhead and delays described in the reference. The workflow creates a Catalog Task after approval, assigns it to the Hardware group and provides a traceable path from Service Catalog request to configuration activity.

The reference concludes that this streamlined process supports timely configuration, reduces user waiting time, optimises resource allocation and improves the overall procurement experience. This report preserves those project conclusions while avoiding unsupported numerical claims.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

- Add explicit handling for rejected, cancelled and failed requests.
- Extend the workflow to other standard hardware categories.
- Introduce notifications to users and support teams at key status changes.
- Add measurable SLA/response-time monitoring and reporting.
- Add approval rules based on request attributes if required.
- Maintain a formal test evidence set with screenshots and execution results.

11. APPENDIX

A. Configuration Summary

- Flow Name: Standard Laptop Task.
- Application: Global.
- Run user: System user.
- Trigger: Service Catalog.
- Action: Create Catalog Task.
- Request item input: Requested Item Record.
- Short description: Laptop need to Configured.
- Description: Laptop need to Configured.
- Assignment group: Hardware.
- Approval: Approved.
- Catalog item: Standard Laptop.

B. Source Code

Not applicable / not provided in the reference. The project is configured through ServiceNow Flow Designer rather than a conventional source-code listing.

C. Dataset Link

Not applicable / not provided in the reference.

D. GitHub & Project Demo Link

Not provided in the supplied reference materials.

E. Project Metadata

Field	Value
Team ID	6ab75a49da631abbf0cded44
Date	October 2026
Reference Project	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designe
Template Used	Final Report Template

End of Report